LISTEN · LEARN · SPEAK

Why Talking to Yourself Is Actually Smart

How saying a word out loud helps you find things, the tiny self-talk trick that calms you down, five ways to practise English on your own – and Jack's football coach.



Name: _____

Date: _____

My score: _____ / 100 ⭐

★ How to use this worksheet

1 · Before you listen 🧠
Do the warm-up and learn the key words. Questions with 🧠 can be answered before listening.

2 · While you listen 🎧
Answer the 🎧 questions. The ⏱ times show where to find each part of the video.

3 · After you listen 💬
Find the secret message, write your own pep talk – and read your answers out loud!

0 Warm-up: My self-talk check

fun · no points

Be honest! Tick everything that is true for you. 😄

- ☐ 🔍 I say things' names to find them
- ☐ 🚿 I talk in the shower
- ☐ 📞 I practise before phone calls
- ☐ 😤 I mutter when I'm annoyed
- ☐ 💪 I give myself pep talks
- ☐ 🙈 I've been caught talking to myself

My self-talk score: _____ / 6

Guess! People looked for a teapot in a picture. Saying *"teapot"* out loud…

(a) made them slower (b) helped them find it faster (c) didn't change anything

🎧 **Check your guess at ⏱ 2:16**

Jack: "I argue in the shower – and I always win!" 🚿



💬 Let's talk

Say your answers out loud – yes, to yourself! – or write them in your notebook.

1. Do you ever talk to yourself? When and where?

2. What do you usually say to yourself when you're nervous?

3. How do you practise speaking English when you're alone?

4. What's the best advice a teacher or coach ever gave you?

1 Key words

vocabulary · 10 points

Match each word or phrase (1–10) to its meaning (a–j). Write the letter in the box. 🧠 Then check at ⏱️ 12:54 and ⏱️ 13:48

- ☐ **1.** to think out loud
- ☐ **2.** to rehearse
- ☐ **3.** to narrate
- ☐ **4.** a pep talk
- ☐ **5.** to mutter
- ☐ **6.** your inner voice
- ☐ **7.** to go blank
- ☐ **8.** to go over something
- ☐ **9.** on my own
- ☐ **10.** a challenge

a) to describe what is happening while it happens, like a commentator
b) when your mind suddenly becomes empty
c) to speak quietly, so other people can't really hear
d) to say your thoughts aloud while you decide or solve something
e) alone, without other people
f) the voice in your head that you hear when you think
g) something difficult, but possible
h) to practise something before you do it for real
i) to check or review something carefully
j) a short speech to encourage someone



Pronunciation corner 🔊 **MUT**-ter · re-**HEARSE** (/rɪˈhɜːs/) · re-**HEAR**-sal · nar-**RATE** · **PEP** talk · **IN**-ner **VOICE**. Say it out loud – to yourself: *"Come on, you've got this!"*

2 First listen: the big idea

listening · 2 points

Watch the whole episode once without stopping. Which sentence is the **main message**? 🎧

- (a) Talking to yourself is a bad sign, so it's better to stop doing it.
- (b) Only famous athletes should talk about themselves using their own name.
- (c) Talking to yourself – kindly, and in English – can help you find things, stay calm and practise speaking.



Lucy's tip: First listen = the **big picture**. Don't stop the video and don't worry about every word. Second listen = the **details**. That's when you answer the 🎧 questions.

🔮 **Predict before you listen!** (no points) Seven of these words are in the episode. One is **not**. Circle the one you think you **won't** hear – then check while you listen.

lentils · **teapot** · **cola** · **onions** · **peeler** · **piano** · **football** · **wedding**

3 Know it or hear it? quiz + listening 10 points

Circle a, b or c. Questions 🧠 1–5: you can probably answer them **before** you listen. Questions 🎧 6–10: listen to find the answer.



🧠 YOU MIGHT ALREADY KNOW

1. If you "mutter", you…

(a) speak quietly, so others can't really hear
(b) shout at someone
(c) sing very loudly

🧠 Look at Exercise 1

2. "Who are you talking _____?"

(a) with
(b) to
(c) at

🧠 Grammar you know

3. "I said to _____, 'Don't worry.'"

(a) me
(b) myself
(c) mine

🧠 Tricky – think about it!

4. A "pep talk" is…

(a) a long, boring lecture
(b) an argument with a friend
(c) a short speech to encourage someone

🧠 Look at Exercise 1

5. "Come on, you've got this!" means…

(a) You can do it!
(b) It's in your bag.
(c) Give it to me.

🧠 Everyday English

🎉 **How many did you know?**
Now press play and test your ears!

🎧 LISTEN AND FIND OUT

6. What was Lucy looking for in the supermarket?

(a) lentils
(b) butter
(c) a teapot

🎧 ⏱️ 0:05

7. When people said the name of a product they didn't know well, it…

(a) helped a lot
(b) slowed them down
(c) made them laugh

🎧 ⏱️ 2:16

8. About how many people took part in Ethan Kross's seven studies?

(a) sixty
(b) six thousand
(c) nearly six hundred

🎧 ⏱️ 4:31

9. What does Lucy usually say to herself when she's nervous?

(a) "Why do you always do this?"
(b) "Lucy, you've got this."
(c) "Lucy, don't mess this up."

🎧 ⏱️ 7:46

10. How old was Jack when he learned his special sentence?

(a) twelve
(b) sixteen
(c) twenty-one

🎧 ⏱️ 17:32

👓 **Fun fact:** Jack's mum mutters *"Glasses, glasses…"* when she looks for her glasses – and they're always on her head!

4 True or false? listening 6 points

Listen and circle **T** (true) or **F** (false). The ⏱️ times help you find the answer.

1	Lucy pretended to be on the phone – but she wasn't holding a phone.	T	F	⏱️ 0:05
2	Jack has arguments in the shower, and he always loses.	T	F	⏱️ 0:05
3	People who said the word out loud found the object faster.	T	F	⏱️ 2:16
4	Saying a name helps most when you know what the thing looks like.	T	F	⏱️ 2:16
5	Kross was mainly interested in *whether* people talk to themselves.	T	F	⏱️ 4:31
6	Talking to yourself always helps, whatever you say.	T	F	⏱️ 7:46



5 Two studies and a coach 🔍 listening 6 points

Who or what is each sentence about? Write **A**, **B** or **C**. ⏱️ 2:16 · 4:31 · 17:32

A · Finding things 🫖
2012 · Lupyan & Swingley · saying names out loud

B · Stress 😰
2014 · Ethan Kross, University of Michigan · "I" or your name?

C · Mr Davies ⚽
Jack's football coach, when Jack was twelve

1	People prepared a short speech with very little time.	☐
2	People looked for one object, like a teapot, among lots of pictures.	☐
3	He sat down next to Jack in the changing room.	☐
4	Saying the name of a familiar product, like cola, helped people find it.	☐
5	He asked, "What are you saying to yourself?"	☐
6	People who used their own name felt less anxious, and their speeches were rated as better.	☐



6 Challenge or threat? new! think about it 4 points

A **challenge** is difficult, but possible. A **threat** is something dangerous. How does each sentence see the situation? ⏱️ 4:31

1. "This is hard, but I can do it."
☐ 💪 CHALLENGE ☐ ⚠️ THREAT

2. "This is going to destroy me."
☐ 💪 CHALLENGE ☐ ⚠️ THREAT

3. "I'm going to let everyone down."
☐ 💪 CHALLENGE ☐ ⚠️ THREAT

4. "Jack, you've practised. You're ready."
☐ 💪 CHALLENGE ☐ ⚠️ THREAT

7 "Who are you talking to?" listening 10 points



A colleague catches Lucy talking to herself in the office. Listen at ⏱ 11:54 and write **one word** in each gap (1–8). Then answer A and B. The breakdown at ⏱ 12:54 can help.



JACK
Lucy? Are you okay? Who are you talking 1 _____?



LUCY
Oh! Sorry. Nobody. I was just thinking out 2 _____.



JACK
It sounded like you were having a serious argument.



LUCY
I was 3 _____ what I'm going to say in the meeting this afternoon. I always get 4 _____, so I practise first.



JACK
That's actually a really good idea. Does it help?



LUCY
It really does. By the time I'm in the meeting, I've already said it three times, so it comes 5 _____ more naturally.



JACK
Maybe I should try that. I always go 6 _____ in meetings.



LUCY
Try it. And give yourself a little 7 _____ talk before you go in. "Come on, Jack, you've 8 _____ this."



JACK
In the toilets, maybe. Not in the middle of the office.



LUCY
Wherever works for you. Honestly, nobody really notices.



JACK
Well, I noticed.



LUCY
Okay, almost nobody.

A. Very formal: "_____ whom are you talking?"

B. Jack's pep talk place: in the _____

Your turn to rehearse speak · no points

Think of a conversation **you** will have this week (a phone call, a meeting…). Write two lines for each person – then say **both parts** out loud, like Lucy!

Me: _____ **Them:** _____

Me: _____ **Them:** _____

8 Phrases to steal

expressions · 4 points

Match each phrase (1–4) to its meaning (a–d). ⏱️ 0:05 · 12:54

- ☐ **1.** "You've got this!"
- ☐ **2.** "Wherever works for you."
- ☐ **3.** "It comes out more naturally."
- ☐ **4.** "They can't answer back."

a) In any place that's good for you.
b) They can't reply or argue with you.
c) You can do it!
d) It sounds more natural when you say it.

9 Myself, yourself… or each other?

new! reflexive pronouns · 8 points



Complete each sentence with a word from the box. One word is used twice.

myself · **yourself** · **himself** · **herself** · **ourselves** · **themselves** · **each other**

1. I often talk to _____ in the shower. 🚿
2. "Lucy, give _____ a pep talk before the meeting!"
3. Jack's mum muttered to _____: "Glasses, glasses…" 👓
4. Before every important moment, Jack says the sentence to _____.
5. Lucy and Jack agree: "We need to talk to _____ more nicely."
6. Some athletes talk about _____ using their own name.
7. Every week on the podcast, Jack and Lucy talk to _____. 🎙️
8. I practise speaking on my own = I practise speaking by _____.



Jack's tip: by myself = **on my own** = alone. And look at the difference: two people talk to **each other** 👫 – but when you're alone, you talk to **yourself** 🙋.

10 Small word at the end

new! questions · 6 points



In everyday questions, the preposition goes at the **end**. Complete each question with **to**, **for**, **about**, **at**, **from** or **with**. ⏱️ 12:54

1. 🗣️ Who are you talking _____?
2. 🔍 What are you looking _____?
3. 💭 What are you thinking _____?
4. ⚽ Who did you learn that _____?
5. 😂 What are you laughing _____?
6. 💬 Who do you practise English _____?



Lucy's tip: *"Who are you talking to?"* ✓ is natural, everyday English. *"To whom are you talking?"* is correct too – but it sounds very formal, like an old book. 📜

11 Say it better

common mistakes · 10 points

These sentences sound unnatural. Write a more natural version (2 points each). ⏱ 15:47

😐 1. "I speak with myself." 😊 _____

😐 2. "I was thinking with a loud voice." 😊 _____

😐 3. "I said to me, 'Don't worry.'" 😊 _____

😐 4. "Come on, you can!" 😊 _____

😐 5. "I make practice of speaking alone." 😊 _____



Lucy's tip: "Go over" means to check or review something carefully: *"Before the interview, I go over it in my head."* Very useful!



🏠 Five ways to practise on your own

match · no points

Match each way (1–5) to an example (a–e). Then choose one to try today! ⏱ 8:52

- ☐ **1.** 🍳 narrate your day
- ☐ **2.** 📞 rehearse a conversation
- ☐ **3.** 🤔 think out loud
- ☐ **4.** 💪 give yourself a pep talk
- ☐ **5.** 🎙️ record yourself

a) "Hello, I'd like to make an appointment." "Of course, what's your name?"

b) "Okay, Jack. You've prepared. Speak slowly and you'll be fine."

c) "Okay, now I'm cutting the onions. I need a bigger pan."

d) Talk for two minutes on your phone, then listen back.

e) "Should I go to the shop first or the post office? Hmm..."



💜 Be your own friend

write · no points

Change the harsh **"I" voice** into a kind friend's voice. Use **your name** and **"you"**. ⏱ 4:31 · 7:46

😣 "I'm so stupid. I'll never learn English." 💜 _____, you _____

😣 "I'm going to fail this interview." 💜 _____, you _____

😣 "Why do I always do this?" 💜 _____, you _____

⚽ Build a pep talk like Mr Davies

speak · no points

Jack's coach gave him a sentence in four parts. Build your own, then say it out loud three times! ⏱ 17:32

1 · YOUR NAME	2 · WHAT YOU DID	3 · HOW YOU ARE	4 · ONE SMALL ACTION
"Jack,	**you've practised.**	**You're ready.**	**Breathe out, and go."**
_____	_____	_____	_____

12 Clue word search + secret message

puzzle · 10 points



Step 1: Complete each clue – the first letter and the number of letters are given (1 point each). **Step 2:** Find the 10 words in the grid. They go → ↓ ↘ or ↗ and never cross each other.

1. Actors **r**_____ before a play.
2. Lucy: "Where are you, **l**_____?"
3. Jack's mum's **g**_____ are always on her head!
4. Kross changed the **p**_____: "I" → "you".
5. Like a commentator, **n**_____ your day.
6. People had to find an object like a **t**_____.
7. Jack argues with nobody in the **s**_____!
8. To speak quietly, so others can't hear: to **m**_____.
9. "The thing for the potatoes?" "It's a **p**_____!"
10. Mr Davies was Jack's football **c**_____.

T	H	G	L	A	S	S	E	S	E
P	E	P	E	E	L	E	R	R	H
S	R	T	E	A	P	O	T	C	P
L	S	E	O	N	Y	O	A	M	R
E	U	H	H	T	A	O	L	U	O
N	K	T	O	E	C	O	M	T	N
T	O	S	T	W	A	E	V	T	O
I	E	R	Y	D	E	R	A	E	U
L	Y	I	S	Y	O	R	S	R	N
S	N	A	R	R	A	T	E	E	U

🤫 **Step 3 – the secret message** (no points) Cross out the 10 words. Then write the letters that are left, row by row, from left to right. It's Jack's last piece of advice in the episode!

___ _____ ___ _____ __ _____ _____

____ __ ____.

13 Jack and the football coach ⚽

listening · 6 points



Listen at ⏱️ 17:32. Put the events in the right order. Write 1–6 in the boxes.

- ☐ 😰 In the changing room, he told himself, "I'm going to let everyone down."
- ☐ ⚽ At twelve, Jack played in a small local football team.
- ☐ 🗣️ He said the new sentence out loud three times.
- ☐ 😬 Before an important match, he couldn't stop shaking.
- ☐ 😊 He didn't score, but he didn't shake – and he enjoyed the game.
- ☐ 🧓 Mr Davies sat down next to him: "What are you saying to yourself?"

Think about it 💭 (no points) When does Jack still say his sentence today? Write two moments.

14 Your turn

writing · 8 points

2 points for each good sentence. Then read your sentences out loud!



A. Caught! 🙈

When do you talk to yourself? Were you ever caught?
e.g. "I always mutter when I'm looking for my phone."

B. Narrate it 🎙️

Describe what you're doing right now, like a commentator. *e.g. "Right now I'm sitting at my desk and drinking tea."*



⏱️ My talk-to-myself week

your 7-day mission

Talk to yourself in English for five minutes every day. Nobody is listening – so relax!

Day	Mission	A new word or phrase I needed	Done?
1	🍳 narrate your cooking		☐
2	📞 rehearse a phone call		☐
3	🗓️ plan your day out loud		☐
4	🎙️ record yourself: 2 minutes		☐
5	💪 a pep talk with your name		☐
6	🎬 describe a film		☐
7	🎧 listen back to Day 4		☐

✂️ Cut out and keep in your pocket

🗣️ THINK OUT LOUD
I'm just thinking out loud.
I talk to myself.
I said to myself...

💪 PEP TALK
Come on, you've got this!
You can do it!
[Name], you're ready.

🎭 REHEARSE
I rehearse what I'll say.
I go over it in my head.
I always go blank!

💜 BE KIND
Use your name or "you".
Talk like a friend.
A challenge, not a threat.

Can you do it now?

I can...	Not yet	Almost	Yes!
explain why saying a word out loud can help you find something.	😟	🙂	😄
give myself a short pep talk using my name.	😟	🙂	😄
use think out loud, rehearse, narrate and go blank.	😟	🙂	😄
use myself / each other and end questions with "to" or "for".	😟	🙂	😄



Share it with us! Write your own pep talk in the comments – with your name: **"Maria, you've practised, you're ready."** And tell us: have you ever been caught talking to yourself? 🫘😅

Answer key

Count your points and write your score on page 1!

0 · Warm-up & predict

Guess: b – people who said the word out loud found it faster. · Predict: **piano** 🎹 isn't in the episode.

1 · Key words · 2 · The big idea

1 d · 2 h · 3 a · 4 j · 5 c · 6 f · 7 b · 8 i · 9 e · 10 g
Big idea: c (2 points)

3 · Know it or hear it?

1 a · 2 b · 3 b · 4 c · 5 a · 6 a · 7 b · 8 c · 9 c · 10 a

4 · True or false?

1 T · 2 F (he always wins) · 3 T · 4 T · 5 F (he was interested in *how* – which words we use) · 6 F (it depends on what you say)

5 · Two studies and a coach · 6 · Challenge or threat?

5: 1 B · 2 A · 3 C · 4 A · 5 C · 6 B
6: 1 challenge · 2 threat · 3 threat · 4 challenge

7 · "Who are you talking to?"

1 to · 2 loud · 3 rehearsing · 4 nervous · 5 out · 6 blank · 7 pep · 8 got · A To · B toilets

8 · Phrases to steal

1 c · 2 a · 3 d · 4 b

9 · Myself, yourself… · 10 · Small word at the end

9: 1 myself · 2 yourself · 3 herself · 4 himself · 5 ourselves · 6 themselves · 7 each other · 8 myself
10: 1 to · 2 for · 3 about · 4 from · 5 at · 6 with

11 · Say it better (2 points each)

1 I talk to myself. · 2 I was thinking out loud. / I was thinking aloud. · 3 I said to myself, "Don't worry." / I told myself not to worry. · 4 Come on, you can do it! / Come on, you've got this! · 5 I practise speaking on my own.
Five ways: 1 c · 2 a · 3 e · 4 b · 5 d · *Be your own friend, e.g.*: "Ali, you've learned so much already." · "Ali, you've prepared. You're ready."

12 · Word search (1 point per word)

1 rehearse · 2 lentils · 3 glasses · 4 pronoun · 5 narrate · 6 teapot · 7 shower · 8 mutter · 9 peeler · 10 coach
Secret: The person you talk to most every day is you.



13 · The coach story · 14 · Your turn

1 ⚽ local team · 2 😬 shaking · 3 😰 "let everyone down" · 4 🧓 Mr Davies · 5 🗣️ three times · 6 😊 enjoyed the game
Think about it: before exams, job interviews, his brother's wedding speech, the first episode of the podcast.
14: your own answers – 2 points per good sentence.

Your score

90–100 🏆 **You've got this!** · 70–89 ✨ **Great pep talk** · 50–69 🎭 **Still rehearsing** · 0–49 🫘 **Lost in the lentils – listen again!**

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